CRIMINAL BLUNDER 1

Murder passed off as suicide

In a petition they filed at the division bench of the Chief Justice of the Kolkata High Court on August 12, the victim's sexagenarian parents, who work in a tailoring shop, alleged that the hospital authorities, with the assistance of the police, made concerted efforts to suppress the true nature of the incident after the discovery of their daughter's body. "They prematurely labelled her death a suicide, even before a proper post mortem examination was conducted," reads their petition. The autopsy report records their daughter's death between 3 am and 5 am on August 9, but the parents received their first phone call from the assistant superintendent of the hospital, Dwaipayan Biswas, at 10.53 am that day, and that too to be told that their daughter was unwell. Twenty-two minutes later, at 11.15 am, the same individual called again to inform them she had died by suicide.

While hearing the case, the Supreme Court questioned the sequence of events and the delays in registration of FIR by the Kolkata police—the crime was detected in the early hours of the morning, but the FIR was filed only late at night. Worse, when her parents rushed to the hospital after being informed of their daughter's death, they were denied access to the body which, their petition asserts, "indicate[s] a deliberate attempt to tamper with evidence".

The fact that the principal, Dr Sandip Ghosh, didn't lodge a formal complaint also leaves room for suspicion. The first FIR in the case was filed by the parents at the Tala police station at 11.45 pm on August 9.

↘ Assistant supdt of hospital calls up parents first to say their daughter is unwell. Later, calls to say she has committed suicide

↘ First FIR filed only after cremation, and that too by the parents

The girl's parents in their petition said "they have come to know that there were no clothes on the lower part of their daughter's body, and there were visible signs of severe torture. The condition of her body strongly suggested that she had been brutally raped and murdered...(there were) multiple abrasions, bruises, and clear signs of a violent struggle, including bleeding from her vagina, lips, and eyes".

Blaming the media for spreading misinformation, Kolkata police commissioner Vineet Goyal has defended his force, saying, "There was no attempt to call the crime a 'suicide', as is being erroneously reported from certain quarters. The police never called it a suicide."



NEW GUARDS
RAF personnel deployed at RG Kar Hospital after the Aug. 14 vandalism incident

CRIMINAL BLUNDER 2

The suspect who has the run of RG Kar